

In low-light scenarios, the primary sensor is a star performer. Images captured in night mode display excellent detail retention and minimal noise, even in challenging lighting conditions. The ultrawide camera also holds its own in low light, though the edges of the frame can sometimes lose a bit of sharpness. Indoor photography under artificial lighting produces vibrant images with accurate colour reproduction, making it a reliable performer across a range of environments.

Master Mode, a feature designed for professional-level photography, adds another layer of versatility to the camera system. This mode enhances images to make them look polished and ready for social media or professional use. However, it's not without its flaws. In low-light conditions, shadows can occasionally appear crushed, detracting from the overall quality of the image. To get the best results, it's advisable to use Master Mode in well-lit environments.

On the video front, the Find X8 Pro impresses with its ability to shoot 4K footage at 60 fps using both the rear and front cameras. Video quality is excellent, with sharp details, accurate colours, and smooth stabilization. The phone also includes a range of creative tools for videographers, allowing for advanced adjustments and effects.

Overall, the OPPO Find X8 Pro's camera system is one of the most comprehensive and high-performing setups on the market. With innovative hardware, clever AI enhancements, and a partnership with Hasselblad, this phone is a dream for anyone serious about mobile photography.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

In our tests, the Find X8 Pro achieved a score of 2.2 million on AnTuTu, a modest 6.32% improvement over last year's iQOO 12 with the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3. However, it significantly trailed the Snapdragon 8 Elite-powered phone we tested alongside it, with a gap of 20.77% in raw performance metrics. Geekbench scores further highlighted the Dimensity 9400's limitations in peak performance. The Find X8 Pro's single-core score lagged

behind even last year's flagships, such as the Xiaomi 14 and iQOO 12, while the multi-core performance offered only incremental improvements. However, where the Dimensity 9400 truly shines is in sustained performance. In our CPU throttling test, the Find X8 Pro demonstrated significantly less throttling than the Snapdragon 8 Elite phone. Not only did it maintain a higher average score, but it also achieved a better maximum score, indicating that this chipset is built for consistent performance during prolonged tasks.

This makes the Find X8 Pro a compelling option for users who prioritise consistent performance over peak numbers, especially for tasks like gaming and multitasking. That said, the phone did experience some heating during extended gaming sessions and while capturing photos or videos, despite its vapour chamber cooling system.

On the software side, ColorOS 15 based on Android 15 offers a smooth and polished experience. OPPO has introduced a new feature called Touch to Share, enabling seamless file transfers between the Find X8 Pro and Apple devices like iPhones and iPads. The updated user interface is visually appealing, and the AI features integrated into the software add convenience without feeling intrusive. In our Digit AI-Q Score evaluation, the phone scored a respectable 81/100, indicating its strong AI and software capabilities.

OPPO also promises a robust long-term update policy, with five years of OS updates and six years of security patches. In day-to-day usage, the OPPO Find X8 Pro is buttery smooth, offering a lag-free experience. While it doesn't quite match the sheer performance metrics of Snapdragon 8 Elite phones, it strikes a balance between stability and efficiency, making it a reliable flagship performer.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery technology is another area where the Find X8 Pro leads the pack. The phone is equipped with a 5910 mAh silicone-carbon battery, which offers significantly better longevity compared to traditional

lithium-ion batteries while also having a smaller footprint. In testing, the Find X8 Pro managed an impressive 16 hours and 7 minutes in the PCMark battery benchmark, making it one of the most long-lasting flagships available.

The fast-charging capabilities are equally impressive. The 80W SuperVOOC charging can take the battery from 0 to 100% in just 49 minutes, while the 50W wireless charging option provides added convenience for users who prefer a cable-free experience. However, the phone's power-hungry features, such as the high refresh rate display and intensive camera usage, can drain the battery faster during heavy use.

VERDICT

The OPPO Find X8 Pro is a testament to the company's ability to innovate and refine. From its exceptional camera system to its enduring battery life and sleek design, the phone checks most of the boxes that flagship buyers look for. While it isn't without its flaws—such as the slightly underwhelming fingerprint sensor and lower resolution display—it more than makes up for these shortcomings with its strengths. For those seeking a smartphone that excels in photography, offers great battery performance, and provides a premium user experience, the Find X8 Pro is an excellent choice. However, if you're looking for a phone that leads the pack in benchmark numbers, it would be best to wait for upcoming Snapdragon 8 Elite phones like the Realme GT 7 Pro and iQOO 13.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 9400 | CPU: Octa-core | GPU: Immortalis-G925 | OS: Android 15, ColorOS 15, 5 major Android updates | IP Rating: IP68/69 | Display: 6.78" LTPO AMOLED, 1 B colours, Dolby Vision, HDR10+, 1264 x 2780 pixels | Refresh rate: 120 Hz | Display protection: Gorilla Glass 7i | Cameras: 50 MP (Main) + 50 MP (3x) + 50 MP (6x) + 50 MP (UW) | Selfie camera: 32 MP | Video: Up to 4K at 60 fps | Battery capacity: 5,910 mAh Si/C | Charging: 80 W wired, 50 W wireless

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